KKR KCS cheat sheet: one page, read it in the lift

THE ONE SENTENCE

"KCS is the team that has to understand all of KKR. KKR is built for that seat: one P&L and one compensation pool, Capital Markets beside it, and a client base that now runs from pensions to private wealth. I want to learn the whole firm by explaining it honestly to the people who fund it."

ANSWER PROTOCOL (45 TO 75 SECONDS)

1. **Steady** (3s): pause, breathe. "Let me make sure I understand the situation."
2. **Sort** (10s): name what is at stake. "There are two things here: X and Y."
3. **Act** (30s): what you would do, in order, and who you would tell.
4. **Close** (10s): the principle. "Because accuracy and the client's trust come before speed."

PRIORITY ORDER WHEN GOOD THINGS COLLIDE

1. The rules and KKR's name (accuracy, marketing rules, information walls)
2. The client's real interest; every client treated fairly
3. The process and the record (CRM, compliance sign-off)
4. Speed

Holding line: "I'd rather be a day late than wrong in front of a client."

NEVER SAY

- "KKR is the biggest" (Blackstone $1.35tn, Apollo $1.05tn; KKR $796bn)
- "KKR leads private wealth" (Blackstone about $324bn vs K-Series $42bn)
- "Only KKR has in-house capital markets" (BXCM, Apollo Capital Solutions)
- "Industrialist vision" as KKR's words (not found in KKR material)
- Anything bad about a rival, a past employer or a client
- A number you cannot source

FRAME BREAKERS AND COUNTERS

Interruption	Finish the clause, then answer them
"That's wrong"	"What makes you see it that way?" then hold or update with a reason
Silence	Stop. Do not fill it. "Shall I go deeper on any part?"
Escalation	Same principle, higher stakes, same answer
"The MD says"	Respect, then the rule: "I'd ask compliance first"
False choice	"Is there a third option, like..."
Knowledge trap	"I don't know that; here's how I'd find out"
Badmouth bait	Describe the trade-off, not the people

NUMBERS IF ASKED (30 JUN 2026 UNLESS STATED)

AUM / fee-paying AUM	$796.5bn / $638.4bn
Capital raised	$129bn in 2025 (record); $133bn last 12m
2024-26 target	$300bn; $305bn raised by Jun 2026
K-Series (wealth)	$6bn (2023) to $42bn
Investor mix	Private wealth 18%, pensions 14% of AUM (10-K)
KCS	Formed 2009; 300+ people
Global Atlantic	$220bn AUM
Employees own	about 30% of KKR stock
GII V (infra)	$19.2bn close, Aug 2026, KKR's largest
London	18 Hanover Square; EMEA co-heads Davies and Caprioli

LINES TO HAVE READY

- **KCS in one line:** covering clients, explaining products, building new ones, across institutions, families and private wealth.
- **KCS and KCM:** KKR underwrites a deal, KCM syndicates co-invest, KCS brings the clients.
- **Culture:** "People do business with those they like and trust" (Kravis); Walter Industries, 17 years to make investors whole.
- **DPI:** cash actually returned divided by cash paid in. The metric LPs care most about now.
- **Evergreen vs drawdown:** continuous entry, limited redemptions (gates) vs commit once, called over years.

THIS WEEK'S CONTEXT

- Q3 results expected 9 Nov 2026
- Sunset Date: founders' control ends by 31 Dec 2026, one share one vote
- DOJ: proposed $250m settlement over merger filings (Aug 2026)
- UK: Pension Schemes Act 2026; FCA CP26/28 closes 14 Oct
- EU: AIFMD II applied from 16 Apr 2026
- Wealth redemptions: K-FIT paid about 80% in Q1, 100% in Q2

ONE QUESTION TO ASK

"Mark Danzey heads both Capital Markets and Institutional Client Solutions in Europe. In practice, when KCM syndicates a co-investment, how does KCS decide which clients see it first, and what does a junior do in that process?"

Sources for every number are in the body of the pack: Q2 2026 release and 10-Q, FY2025 10-K, KKR people directory and postings, Kravis pages on kkr.com, WS3 peer filings. Prepared 12 Oct 2026; check the latest quarter before any interview.